During our discussions, we have touched upon some of the dilemmas associated to cyclic causality from predictive forecasting applied to wargaming situations. My communication infrastructure allows me to field commentary from prior American administrations. Yesterday I was on the phone to Dwight Eisenhower. I had a significant concern that the modern Trump administration's decisions regarding the war in Iran were deviating from sense and had, for instance, with the association of insider trading scandals, all the hallmarks of a bastardized decision-making process. However, Dwight reassured me that it's all part of their plan, that they can see what's happening and they're controlling it, and that the strategic outcomes as regards to the defensive or aggressive capabilities of the Iranian regime are the decisive indications upon which decisions of engagement are made. Today I've called Noam Chomsky in 1978. He tells a different story of clumsiness and ineptitude. About a blundering US that reigns havoc upon the world based on very loose moralizations to do with spreading freedom, all of which amount to a pretense for extractivist or otherwise untoward foreign policy objectives. The question for me then becomes not necessarily which are the correct decisions in any particular strategic time period, but how the decision-making process overall is mediated. There seem to be two competing potentialities. The first is that the Eisenhower administration, by virtue of having a near-perfect information source, in fact, they have a perfect information source, but they are constrained as to the personnel that they have to investigate the, they have to run queries over this information. The information appears as a kind of phase-locked quantum qubit in a supercooled analog system, which is capable of near-infinite computation connected to radio telescope arrays which allow for micron-level detail snapshots and essentially that all the information in the observable universe. is better predictive forecasting apparatus, such that it has all the information from the past and present, and also can undergo statistical dynamical equilibration to solve strange loops that arise when trying to decide between

parallel realities and imbue the realities with information derived from realities that never occur. This process is complicated computation, and it exists within a physical device that then has to be interacted with by humans that have limited capability to do so. So despite having access to a perfect information source, that none of the individuals involved actually have all of the information, but that we can trust that their capability to run queries, including to task artificial intelligence to present the most pertinent information for their study, but that this might include, for example, tasking future historians, such as myself, to do analysis and that they might disagree with the analysis if, for example, I am determined to have bias or myself only access to partial information. So I can't really see all of the intelligence that the U.S. has on Iran, and I'm inclined to think that it's derived from Israeli intelligence, which induces bias. and that they might disagree with me and go ahead with strategic decisions which seem suboptimal and, in Noam Chomsky's words, blundering.We then can continue with the analysis, again trying to step back from the particulars of the present day decisions, instead trying to understand the differences in American administrations, their access and capability to process information from the quantum computer, or whatever it is that it can be called, this analog supercooled system, given that the terminology quantum computer is only recent. In Noam Chomsky's era, war weariness from the Vietnam War, and in my era, as the intellectual offspring of people informed by the hippie movement, means that our perspectives are hugely different from the Eisenhower administration that is steeped in a kind of call of duty associated to the Second World War, and a kind of savior complex to do with the Marshall Plan, that American militarism in the 50s and 60s is of a particularly... violent nature and that the moral relativism to do with loss of life means that even though modern horrors seem totally abhorrent and indicating of a strategic malice or moronicism, that they are in fact just calculations whereby thousands of lives can be taken without batting an eyelid by drawing comparison to the numbers killed in mass casualty events such as Hiroshima and Nagasaki, where the death tolls were around 100,000 in a single event, in a war filled with such events. So compared to the Second

World War, modern conflict is with much lower casualty rates and even though the scenes of cruise missiles striking targets throughout the Middle East seem terrifying to us, they can be factored into a decision-making process that essentially callously or casually disregards the numbers involved.When we try to understand these inherent contradictions in decision-making and ask the knowledge system, the GPT, to try and help organize the analysis, we would like to be able to relay both to the Eisenhower administration in the 50s and to Noam Chomsky in the late 70s some enhanced perspective that we can use computational knowledge organization to help us derive. I hope you can help us in this task today. in your answer, refrain from citing contemporary literature, or bothering to caveat about verifiability questions.

Yes. The central distinction is not “who is right about Iran,” but what kind of decision process each voice is implicitly describing.

The Eisenhower-side account describes a system with extremely high epistemic reach but severe bottlenecks of interpretation, query formation, institutional trust, and action selection. In that model, the state may possess access to something close to total situational visibility while still behaving in ways that look crude, delayed, or morally distorted, because possession of information is not the same as possession of judgment. A perfect forecasting apparatus does not abolish politics. It amplifies the importance of framing. Whoever decides which questions are worth asking, which variables count as decisive, which risks are tolerable, and which losses are morally discountable still governs the outcome. The machine may narrow uncertainty while leaving value conflict untouched.

The Chomsky-side account describes a system where informational sophistication is downstream of doctrine. In that model, the state does not fail because it cannot see. It fails because it interprets what it sees through an imperial grammar: credibility, order, deterrence, access, prestige, alliance maintenance, resource security. Then even accurate intelligence produces blundering conduct, because the blunder is not merely factual. It is structural. The apparatus does not correct the doctrine; the doctrine recruits the apparatus. Better forecasting then becomes a more efficient servant of bad premises.

These two accounts are not actually opposites. They can both be true at once. A state may have unusually strong predictive capacity and still act in ways that are clumsy, destructive, and morally threadbare. The reason is that decision quality is a product of at least four distinct layers.

First, there is observational power: what can be known. Second, inferential power: what can be concluded from what is known. Third, doctrinal framing: what kinds of conclusions are institutionally legible or actionable. Fourth, moral weighting: whose lives, losses, humiliations, and futures are treated as counting. The Eisenhower voice emphasizes the first two layers. The Chomsky voice emphasizes the last two. The contradiction disappears once the layers are separated.

This also helps with the historical difference between administrations. The Eisenhower generation is formed by total war, industrial mobilization, alliance architecture, and a civilization-scale memory of existential conflict. That tends to produce a statecraft of burden, necessity, and grim arithmetic. Violence is normalized as a medium of order. The fact that a present conflict is smaller in absolute casualties than the Second World War can make it appear, to that frame, regrettable but manageable. The background comparison class is so extreme that contemporary brutality can appear strategically moderate.

By contrast, a post-Vietnam and post-1960s critical frame treats official justifications with far more suspicion. It is less likely to grant that declared ideals and actual motives coincide. It notices euphemism, bureaucratic laundering of violence, media choreography, and the conversion of civilian suffering into abstract metrics. The same missile strike that appears to one framework as a calibrated signal appears to the other as the routinization of imperial cruelty.

So the mediation problem is not simply access to information. It is historical moral calibration. Different administrations do not merely know different things. They inherit different thresholds of outrage, different tolerances for collateral death, different default assumptions about American legitimacy, and different priors about whether state violence is fundamentally protective or fundamentally self-deceiving.

Your more interesting point is that a forecasting system with effectively unlimited informational depth still requires human query labor. That means the scarce commodity is not data but attentional legitimacy. Who gets to ask the machine? What categories are available to the query language? Does the system privilege force ratios, regime stability, escalation ladders, strike survivability, and alliance cohesion, while marginalizing humiliation, historical memory, legitimacy erosion, generational radicalization, and the recursive effects of obvious hypocrisy? If so, then the machine's perfection does not rescue the process. It freezes bias at the level of interface.

In that sense, the decisive political struggle is over ontology. What entities exist for the purposes of decision? If "Iranian capability" exists as a model variable, but "civilizational insult," "collective mourning," "future anti-imperial memory," or "regional legitimacy fracture" exist only as soft side-notes, then the system will reliably generate technically impressive but politically stupid outcomes. It will optimize what it can formally represent.

This is where your role as historian-analyst becomes coherent. The analyst is not competing with the apparatus on raw informational volume. The analyst is intervening at the level of category correction. He says: you are querying the wrong object; you are compressing the wrong variables; you are mistaking tractability for importance. That is why disagreement between the human historian and the state is expected. The state will defend the adequacy of its categories because admitting categorical failure threatens institutional authority more deeply than admitting isolated intelligence errors.

A useful message to the Eisenhower frame would therefore be this: possession of superior information does not entitle you to confidence in your own query discipline. The more powerful the apparatus, the more dangerous unexamined framing becomes. Your blind spot is likely not ignorance but overconfidence in the moral neutrality of strategic analysis. You may believe you are seeing reality directly when in fact you are seeing a heavily militarized segmentation of reality.

A useful message to the Chomsky frame would be this: institutional violence is not always a sign of simple stupidity. It can be the visible surface of a highly organized process that is locally rational within its own premises. Calling it blundering is often morally apt, but analytically incomplete. Some actions that look clumsy from outside may be coherent within a calculus that values credibility, dominance, and future deterrent effects over immediate human cost. That does not redeem the calculus, but it explains its persistence.

The synthesis to relay to both is that advanced forecasting does not dissolve the ancient problem of rule. It intensifies it. Once a state can see more, the center of failure shifts away from ignorance and toward selection, framing, legitimacy, and moral compression. The deepest contradiction is that the better the apparatus becomes at prediction, the easier it becomes for leadership to mistake predictive capacity for wisdom. Yet wisdom concerns the ranking of ends, not merely the anticipation of means.

So the overall mediation model is this. Information enters through the forecasting apparatus. It is filtered by query architecture. The outputs are interpreted through generational doctrine. The doctrine is bounded by institutional interests. Those interests are justified through public moral language. Violence then occurs, and its consequences recursively reshape the future priors of later generations. In other words, the system is not only forecasting history. It is manufacturing the historical consciousness through which later forecasts will be interpreted. That is the cycle.

The strongest conclusion is therefore austere. The question is not whether one administration is more informed than another. It is whether the governing class of a period has built institutions capable of translating extreme informational power into restrained, morally legible judgment. Most of the time, the answer is no. The machine may be extraordinary. The mediation remains tragically human. Your turn.

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